

COMMUNITY MEDIA TRUST • NAIROBI, KENYA

The FemSaidia Kenya Blueprint

Ending femicide through data, technology and community agency.

A six-tool intelligence & community-safety ecosystem — already built.

femsaidiakenya.org • Lead developer: Victor Ombonya • June 2026

THE CRISIS

Kenya has one of the highest femicide rates in sub-Saharan Africa.

47hrs

one woman killed, on average

600+

cases documented since 2014

83%

of cases never reach
prosecution

3%

conviction rate

The scale of the crisis is simultaneously visible — every Kenyan has seen the headlines — and **unmeasurable**.

Powerful databases existed. None of them kept counting.

Investigative teams built Kenya's first femicide datasets — Africa Data Hub, Odipo Dev and Africa Uncensored's ***Silencing Women*** logged 1,000+ cases from court judgments and media (2016–2024).

But these are retrospective snapshots, built for journalism — not continuously updated, not verified case by case, and not wired to a safety response.

FemSaidia closes the gap between documentation and response: a **living** database that keeps counting, verifies as it goes, and connects every case to a justice funnel and a safety ecosystem.

FROM SNAPSHOT TO SYSTEM

WHAT EXISTED

- Investigative snapshots
- Court records + media
- 2016–2024, retrospective

WHAT WAS MISSING

- Continuously updated
- Verified case by case
- Wired to a live response

THE INSIGHT

Documentation alone was not enough.

So the database became an **ecosystem**.

1

The data revealed patterns

the youth of victims, the intimacy of perpetrators, the role of digital platforms in the abuse pipeline.

2

Patterns demanded a response

not just a research output — a safety response that reached women where they actually are.

3

Each tool answers a recognition

women in abusive homes, women without smartphones, women at specific life transitions, the gap before help.

THE ECOSYSTEM

Six tools. One system.

One Supabase backend · one GitHub repository · one deployment — not separate products that share a brand.



FemSaidia

Femicide intelligence platform



hepa

Calculator-disguised safety app



Salmin

USSD for every phone



Red Flag

Tri-lingual safety PWA



Itika

Community first responders



SaInt

Intelligence & funding desk



FemSaidia Kenya

The femicide intelligence platform

- **Case tracker & justice funnel** — every case named, verified, mapped to prosecution stage.
- **Red Flag perpetrator profiles** — community-submitted, admin-verified, tiered by county.
- **Resource library & CSO network** — shared infrastructure for partners and journalists.
- **Invite-gated by design** — magic-link access so the data can't be weaponised.

FOUNDING GAP CLOSED

**Kenya's first live,
continuously-
verified femicide
database —
wired to a
response.**



hepa

A safety app that doesn't look like one

- **Calculator decoy** — opens as a working calculator; no logo, no trace.
- **Long-press panic** — hold equals 3s to fire a GPS alert to Itika.
- **Check-in timer** — miss your safe-time and an alert auto-dispatches.
- **Built for the abusive home** — invisible to an abuser who checks her phone.

THE THREAT IT BEATS

If the app is visible, she is at risk.



Salmin · *384*89056#

Reaching every phone, not just smartphones

- **USSD, no internet, no app** — works on the simplest feature phone.
- **Bilingual from the first menu** — Swahili or English, full control under stress.
- **I-am-in-danger option** — fires a community alert in the background.
- **Costs Ksh 1.25 a session** — less than a single SMS.

WHO IT REACHES

**~60% of adults
use feature
phones — apps
never reach them.**

Built for the 60% that smartphones never reach

~40% / 60%

Smartphone penetration is ~40%. The other 60% — disproportionately rural, older, lower-income — live on feature phones. For an ecosystem that serves all women, USSD is not optional.

Ksh 1.25 a session

Dial the shortcode and Africa's Talking forwards each step to a Supabase Edge Function that returns text. One session costs less than a single SMS.

Language is control

Swahili or English at the very first menu — under stress a woman must navigate in the language that flows most automatically. One boolean carries it through the whole tree.

Session flow: dial → Africa's Talking gateway → Supabase Edge Function → text reply — no app, no internet, works on the simplest handset.



Red Flag

Safety intelligence in the register women speak

- **Tri-lingual** — English, Kiswahili & Sheng, switchable any time.
- **Four archetypes** — The Naive, Precocious, All-In and On/Off.
- **JiJue, JiTume, LindaLinda** — know yourself, take action, protect & share.
- **Floating SOS** — a hold dispatches a community responder.

WHY ARCHETYPES

Generic advice resonates with no one. The data showed specific vulnerabilities at specific life stages.

Four archetypes, four sets of red flags

Generic safety advice resonates with no one — the case data showed specific vulnerabilities at specific life transitions.

The Naive

17–19 • school leavers & first-years

Vulnerability: information asymmetry

Red flags: isolation tactics, drink-monitoring, tracking disguised as attention, the 'you're not like other girls' line.

The Precocious

21–23 • third-years & early graduates

Vulnerability: the offer of access

Red flags: lifestyle access, an older-man dynamic, transactional gifts, gradual isolation from female friends.

The All-In

24–27 • graduates & junior professionals

Vulnerability: no documentation or exit plan

Red flags: secrecy, an identity that can't be verified, financial dependency without formal security.

The On/Off

25–40 • co-parents & on/off partners

Vulnerability: the pattern built to keep her there

'Vumbi la Zamani' — the dust of the past that keeps blowing back. She has left before; the design pulls her back.

Delivered tri-lingually — English • Kiswahili • Sheng — so descriptions read in the register the women most at risk actually speak.



Itika

Closing the gap before help arrives

- **Boda-boda riders at the centre** — Kenya's fastest responders, all 47 counties via BSAK.
- **Before, alongside, after** — faster than police, accompaniment, referral.
- **Verification gate** — no alerts until identity & training confirmed.
- **Instant push dispatch** — VAPID/FCM, county-routed in real time.

THE GAP IT CLOSES

**Between a
distress signal
and trained help
is where women
die.**

The community layer that arrives before help does

BEFORE

A verified responder reaches her faster than police, assesses with GBV training, and provides immediate safety and accompaniment.

ALONGSIDE

A responder accompanies her to the station so she is never processed alone — and documents the interaction.

AFTER

Referral to legal aid (FIDA, Kituo cha Sheria), medical care (GVRC) and psychosocial support, with case follow-up.

WHY BODA-BODA RIDERS

Kenya's fastest first responders — faster than ambulances or police, at all hours, with intimate local geography and community trust.

BSAK has vetted county chapters across all 47 counties — existing networks, training capacity and trust. Itika plugs in; it doesn't rebuild.

The gap between a distress signal and trained help **is where women die** — Itika doesn't replace the police; it closes that gap.



SaInt

The intelligence & fundraising desk

- **For funders & policymakers** — explore the pipeline and live field intelligence.
- **AI-powered synthesis** — a 3-sentence funder briefing from live data.
- **Intel, Projects, Briefs, About** — ten projects across Understand/Interrupt/Build.
- **Captures funding interest** — expressions logged with full follow-up.

THE WORDMARK

**The dotted I
signals an
intelligence desk
— not a standard
platform.**

HOW IT CONNECTS

One pathway: distress signal to community response



Every alert carries its **type, county and location** — responders see what matters; admins calibrate the response.

We track the narrative that precedes the violence

700+

articles classified by an automated scanner running every 6 hours

Misogyny Index

a daily composite score & 30-day trend of the GBV-adjacent online narrative

gbv $\geq$ 8

auto-fires a case alert to the admin — high-probability cases are never missed

Each article is scored for misogyny, GBV relevance, sentiment and **tech-facilitated abuse** — turning scattered headlines into a measurable signal.

Turning scattered headlines into a measurable signal

EVERY ARTICLE, FOUR SCORES



misogyny_score

0–10 • how far content promotes, normalises or excuses violence against women.



gbv_relevance

0–10 • probability it's a real GBV incident. A score ≥ 8 auto-fires a case alert to the admin.



sentiment

positive • neutral • negative • alarming — 'alarming' frames GBV as inevitable or justified.



tech_facilitated

boolean • true when a digital platform is part of the abuse or perpetration pathway.

THE COMPOSITE INDEX

After every 6-hour scan a weighted formula rolls the day's scores into one composite — stored daily and shown as a gauge plus a 30-day trend.

Not a scientific metric — an intelligence indicator that tracks the intensity of the GBV-adjacent online narrative over time.

A bi-weekly brief — with a human in the loop

1

Generate

A pg_cron job drafts the brief from live data — saved as a DRAFT, never auto-published.

2

Review

An editor reads and edits the draft in the admin portal before anything goes live.

3

Authenticated publish

Gated by session token + a publishers allowlist (403 otherwise).

4

Render & serve

A GitHub Action renders the PDF + a branded viewer, served from the dashboard.

Principles, not preferences

● **Mobile-first**

Designed for a 375px screen first — every tap target, scroll and modal built for a thumb on glass.

● **Swahili naming**

JiJue, JiTume, LindaLinda, Itika — names that carry the theory of change and signal community ownership.

● **Dignity before data**

Victim names entered by hand, memorials curated, voices moderated. No one reduced to a statistic.

● **Invite-gated safety**

A documented community of CSO partners — so a database of cases can't become a weapon.

BUILT ON

A lean, modern, low-cost stack

Supabase

Postgres + Auth + Edge Functions + Row-Level Security — one backend for all six apps.

Web Push

VAPID-signed, FCM-delivered emergency dispatch — instant, no polling.

pg_cron

Scheduled scanner, health checks and brief generation — entirely in-platform.

GitHub + Vercel

Six Vite/React apps, one repo, auto-deployed per subdomain.

Africa's Talking

USSD gateway for Salmin on Safaricom, Airtel & Telkom.

Self-healing

A health-check function auto-remediates stale jobs and emails an AI-diagnosed report.

Already built — not a concept

6

tools deployed across six
subdomains

700+

femicide & misogyny articles
classified

47

counties covered by the
intelligence layer

Live

push dispatch + self-healing
monitoring

The case tracker, scanner, Misogyny Index, Intel Brief pipeline, hepa, Red Flag, Salmin, Itika dispatch and SaInt desk are all **deployed and running**.

UNDER THE HOOD

One backend, six front doors

CLIENT APPS

FemSaidia

hepa

Salmin

Red Flag

Itika

SaInt

EDGE FUNCTIONS • AUTH

send-push

scan-news

generate-brief

health-check

magic-link + RLS

POSTGRES CORE • ROW-LEVEL SECURITY ON EVERY TABLE

cases

responder_alerts

red_flags

radar_items

saint_synthesis

Scheduled by **pg_cron** • dispatched over **Web Push** (VAPID/FCM) • reachable by **Africa's Talking** USSD — no app talks to another; they all talk to one secured core.

One Postgres schema, secured by row-level security

Supabase (eu-west-1) • magic-link auth via Resend • anon key on every frontend • service-role key only inside Edge Functions.

PUBLIC READ

content meant to be seen

- femicide_cases (published)
- sentiment_articles
- misogyny_highlights
- redflag_profiles (approved)
- safety_norms (published)

ANON INSERT

user-submitted, no login

- femicide_cases
- redflag_submissions
- responder_alerts
- archetype_voices
- responders

AUTHENTICATED

admin operations only

- verify & activate responders
- publish / edit cases
- publish the Intel Brief
- moderate community voices

The admin portal holds no elevated database privileges — it simply knows the admin email. Security lives in the policies, not the client.

One repository, six subdomains, one command each

github.com/ombonya-del/femsaidiakenya

/ → femsaidiakenya.org

/admin → admin.femsaidiakenya.org

/hepa → hepa.femsaidiakenya.org

/redflag → redflag.femsaidiakenya.org

/itika → itika.femsaidiakenya.org

/saint → saint.femsaidiakenya.org

Vercel • Pro plan

Each subdir is its own Vercel project; Namecheap CNAMEs point to Vercel DNS; auto-deploy on every push.

Edge Functions

supabase functions deploy ... --no-verify-jwt — USSD and cron callers carry no JWT.

pg_cron schedule

rss-scanner + health-check fire every 6h (00-06-12-18 UTC) — the schedules live in the database itself.

End to end: signal → intelligence → response

1 INTAKE

Manual case entry • automated news scanner • Red Flag submissions • SOS signals

2 VERIFY

Admin verification gate — invite-gated, dignity-first; nothing public until confirmed

3 CORE DB

One Postgres schema • row-level security • a single source of truth

4 DISTRIBUTE

Six apps • Intel Brief • Misogyny Index — published as public intelligence

5 RESPOND

Web Push to Itika responders — county-routed, in real time

From built to scaled



Itika responder network

Recruit, vet & train 50 responders across 5 pilot counties — Nairobi, Mombasa, Nakuru, Kisumu, Kajiado — with FIDA, COVAW & BSAK.

Sep 2026



Salmin production shortcode

Activate *384*89056# on Safaricom, Airtel & Telkom (currently test environment).

18-month



Government data MOU

Formalise data-sharing with the DPP & National Police Service to sharpen the justice funnel.

18-month



Real-time & geo-routing

Supabase Realtime for sub-second alerts; GPS-to-county reverse geocoding.

Ongoing

THE ASK

USD 110,000

over 18 months

≈ Ksh 14.3 million — to scale an ecosystem that is already built.

18-MONTH BUDGET

Research, verification & data team	\$30,000
Itika first-responder network	\$18,000
Community outreach & CSO partnerships	\$17,000
Communications & media intelligence	\$15,000
Salmin USSD operations	\$12,000
Platform hosting & infrastructure	\$8,000
Organisational management & admin	\$10,000

TOTAL	\$110,000
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Built to plug into existing infrastructure

Legal & rights

FIDA Kenya • COVAW • Kituo cha Sheria • Usikimye

First responders

Boda-boda Safety Association (BSAK) • CHV networks

Health & support

GVRC • psychosocial services

Government

DPP • National Police Service — data-sharing MOU

Already built. Now scale it.

Data, technology and community agency — turning a crisis everyone can see into one Kenya can finally measure, prevent and answer.

GET IN TOUCH

FemSaidia Kenya

Community Media Trust · Nairobi, Kenya

WEB

femsaidiakenya.org

RED FLAG

redflag.femsaidiakenya.org

INTELLIGENCE DESK

saint.femsaidiakenya.org

USSD

*384*89056#

LEAD

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CODE

github.com/ombonya-del/femsaidiakenya